Principles and Elements of Interpersonal Communication

1. What is Communication?

Watch the following video to answer these questions:

- What is communication?
- What does effective communication include?
- What does non-verbal communication include?

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- What is communication?

  Sharing information between two people, in a number of different forms

- What does effective communication include?

  Both speaking and listening.

- tion incWhat does non-verbal communicalude?

  Body Language: hand gestures and facial expressions

- **What is communication?**

1. Mass Media (TV, radio)
2. Small-group communication (committee meetings, discussion groups)
3. Large-group communication (lectures, speeches).

- **What is meant by interpersonal communication?**

1. One to one Communication
2. It is a process in which messages are generated and transmitted by one person and subsequently received and understood by another.

2. Elements of Interpersonal Communication

Read the following situation and answer the questions:

George Raymond, a 59-year-old man with moderate hypertension, enters your pharmacy holding an unlit cigar. You know George because you attend the same church. He is a high school principal, has a wife who works, and has four children. He has been told to quit smoking and go on a diet. He also has a long history of not taking his medications correctly. He comes to pick up a new prescription—an antibiotic for a urinary tract infection. Although he knows you personally, he is somewhat hesitant as he approaches the prescription area. He looks down at the ground and mumbles, “The doctor called in a new prescription for me, and can I also have a refill of my heart medication?”

Read the following situation and answer the questions:

- What might be Mr. Raymond thinking of or feeling?
- What clues do you have?
- Write down what you might say to him.

Read the following situation and answer the questions:

- What might be Mr. Raymond thinking of or feeling?
  Embarrassed
- What clues do you have?

  Non-verbal cues ("He looks down at the ground and mumbles"
- Write down what you might say to him.

- **What are the five elements of interpersonal communication?**

  - sender
  - message
  - receiver
  - feedback
  - barriers

Read again and highlight the five elements of communication:

George Raymond, a 59-year-old man with moderate hypertension, enters your pharmacy holding an unlit cigar. **You** know George because you attend the same church. He is a high school principal, has a wife who works, and has four children. He has been told to quit smoking and go on a diet. He also has a long history of not taking his medications correctly. He comes to pick up a new prescription—an antibiotic for a urinary tract infection. Although he knows you personally, he is somewhat hesitant as he approaches the prescription area. He looks down at the ground and mumbles, "**The doctor called in a new prescription for me, and can I also have a refill of my heart medication?**"

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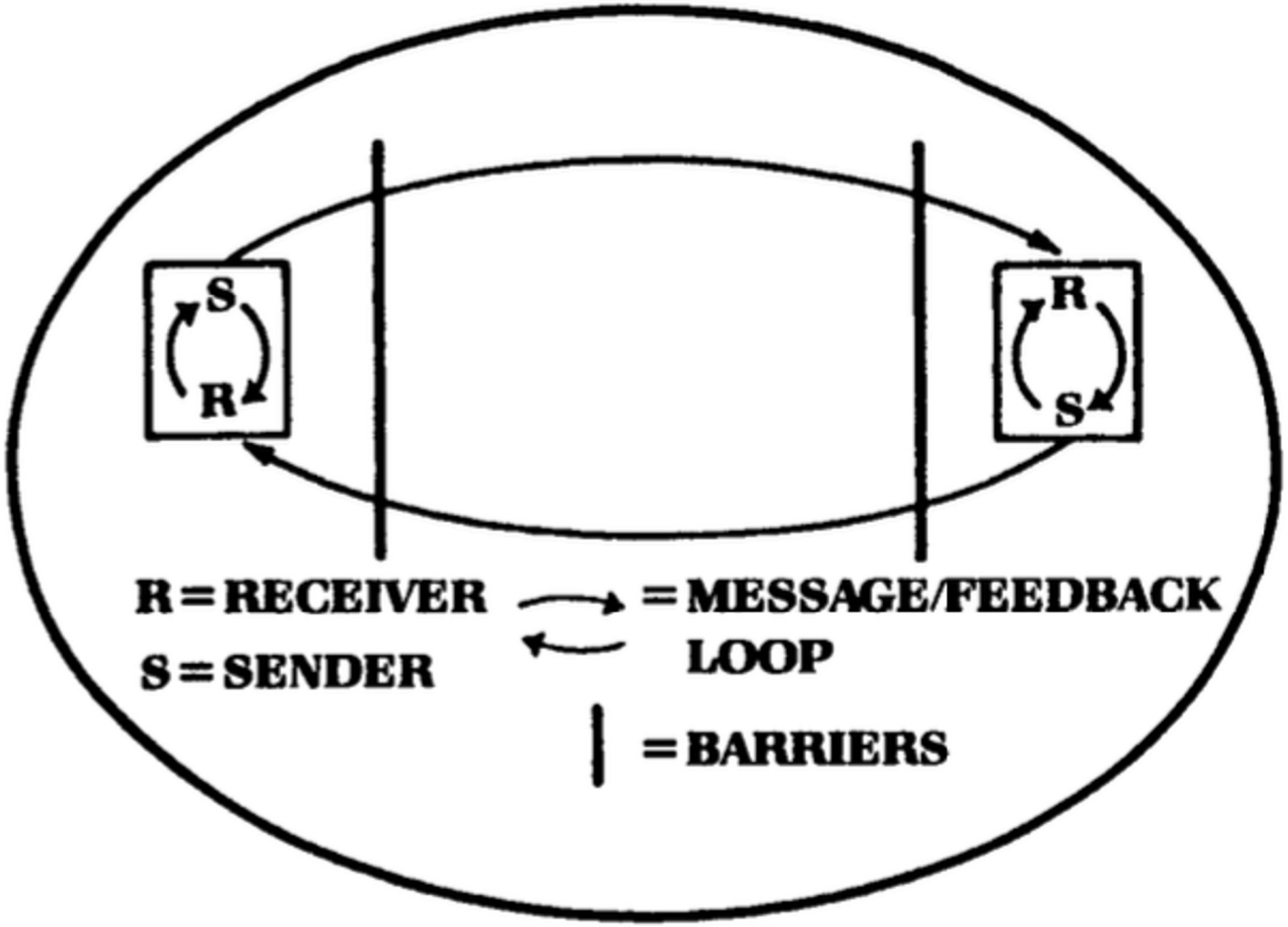
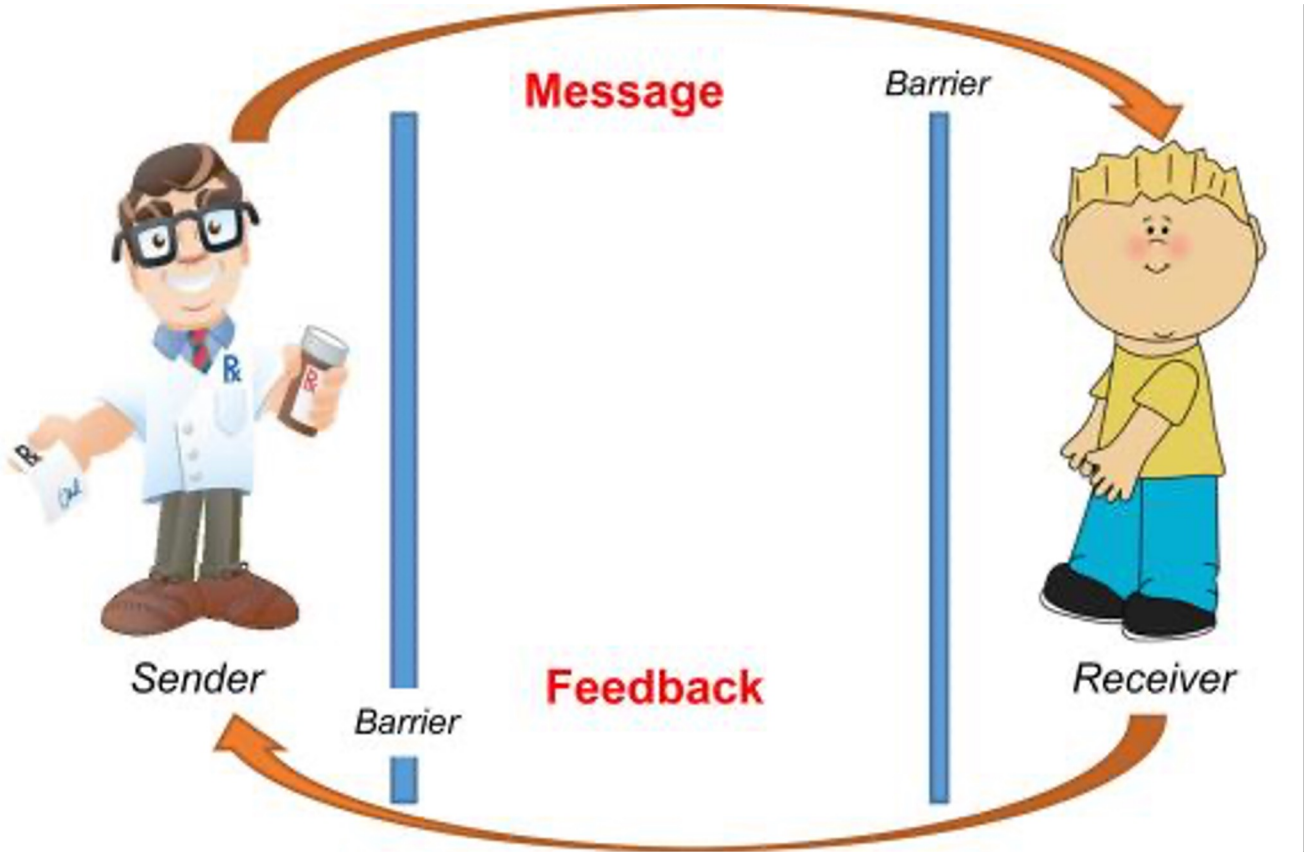


FIGURE 2-1. The interpersonal communication model.

Interpersonal Communication



Match the terms in column A with their definitions in column B

A	B
1. sender e	**a**. Thoughts, ideas, information or emotions that are transmitted from one person to another. They can be transmitted both **verbally** (by talking) and **nonverbally** (by using facial expressions, hand gestures, etc.
2. message a	b. They affect the accuracy of the communication exchange and may lead to misunderstanding or miscommunication.
3. receiver d	**c**. the process whereby receivers communicate back their understanding to the senders.
4. feedback c	**d**. The one who decodes the message and assign a particular meaning to it, which may or may not be the intended meaning of the sender.
5. barriers b	**e**. The one who transmits a message to another person.

Read the following dialogues and identify the 5 interpersonal elements of communication in the following situations:

Dialogue (A)

Patient: Good morning, I need this prescription please.
Pharmacist: One minute, just let me check if it's available.
yes, here they are. Make sure to take them once a day before bed time.
Patient: err.. sorry, I cant hear you… can you repeat again what you have just said.?
(Pharmacist notices the patient adjusting a hearing aid behind his ears)
Pharmacist: I was just saying that you need to take them before you sleep.
Patient: Ok, thanks

Dialogue (B)

Pharmacist: This medication should be taken with plenty of fluids
Patient: Alright, so this means I can take it with a glass of orange juice or milk in the morning.
Pharmacist: Well, it is preferable if you drink it with a large glass of water.
Patient: Can you show me how to apply this nasal inhaler please?
Pharmacist: yes, sure. It is very easy to use. First, hold it in one hand. Then insert the canister tip into your nose, aiming the tip toward the back of your head.
(Telephone rings and Pharmacist picks it up. He talks on the phone for a few seconds before he hangs up)
Sorry, excuse me, yes …. after that use a finger to close the nostril on the side not receiving the medicine. Finally, press down on the canister as you begin to breathe in slowly through your nose.

3. Barriers to Communication

Watch the following video and find all barriers to communication:

Communication Barriers

External communication barriers

- a noisy or otherwise distracting environment (*bright colours, sudden movements)*
- the distance between sender and receiver (*blocking the view*)
- the physical appearance of the message or the sender (*small print, confusing graphics*)
- the use of an inappropriate channel (*personal conversation instead of a memo*)

Internal and verbal barriers

- the receiver's lack of interest in or knowledge about the topic
- the receiver's internal distractions or lack of time
- individual differences in culture and language
- information overload (*too much information*)

Read the following situations and decide which barrier of communication you can find.

- **Teacher:** Today we discussed a number of issues**.** First, we defined interpersonal communication and we talked about the process of communication and its elements. Then, we explained the different styles of communication and how to deal with each one. The last point we discussed is the barriers to communication, their classification into internal and external, and how to overcome them. **Student (to his colleague):** He spoke for three hours. I did not understand anything.

  Information Overload

- **Chinese Doctor**: You need to take this medicine three time a day after each meal.

  American Patient: I am sorry, but are you sure you know what you're talking about? You are Chinese. Are you even a good doctor?

  Bias

Read the following situations and decide which barrier of communication you can find.

- **Father**: Son, please come and help me with something.

  (The TV volume is very high in the background) External Barrier (Noise)

  Son: (Does not respond or move)

- **Doctor**: Because of the cut in your hand, you need to take antibiotics.

  Patient: I am sorry Doctor, but in my country we do not believe we should take any medicine.

  Cultural Differences

4. Communication Styles

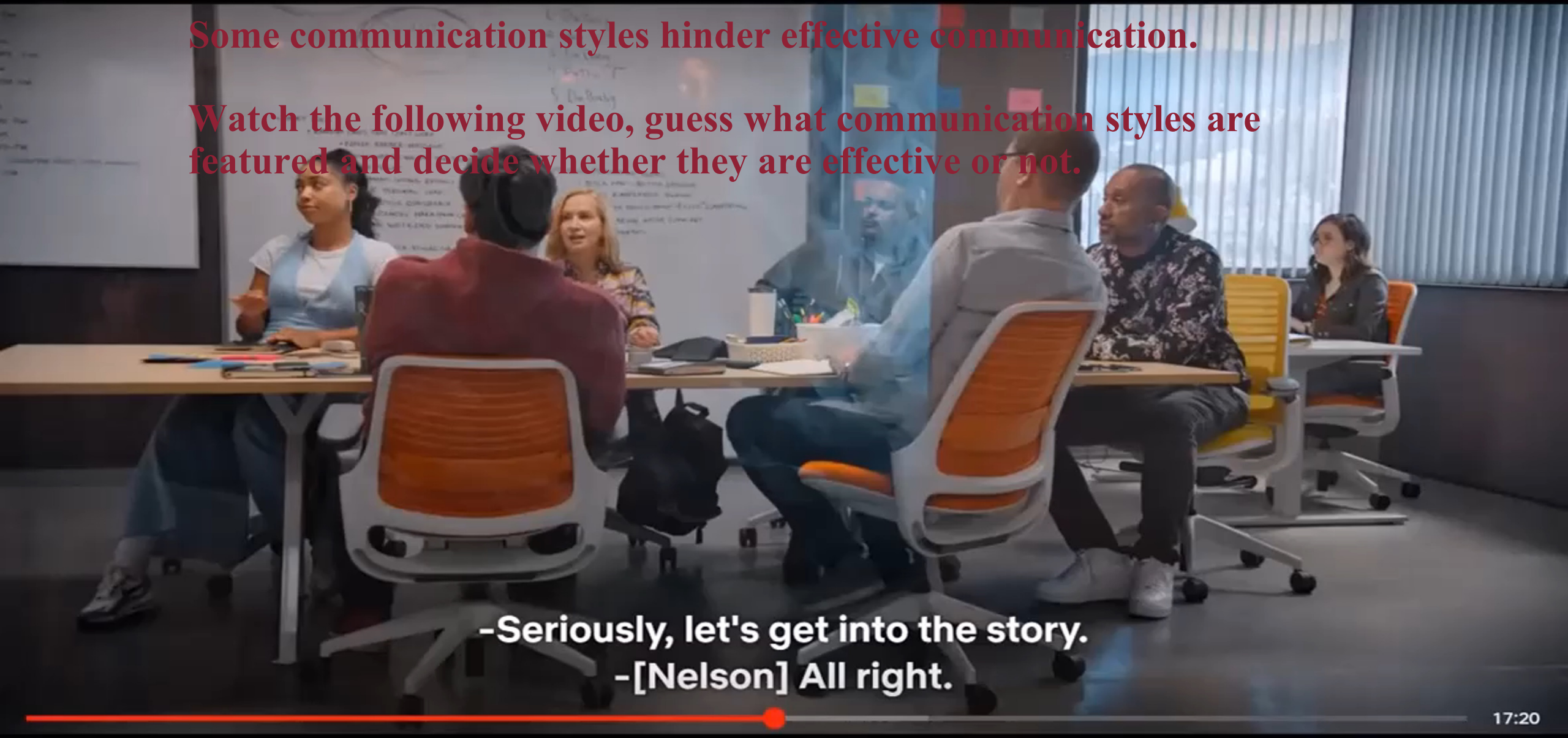
Communication Styles

- A communication style how a person typically expresses themselves and interacts with others when sharing information, feelings, or ideas. It includes word choice, tone of voice, body language, and listening habits.

- People’s communication styles affect how they’re understood and how effectively they connect with others.

Some communication styles hinder effective communication.

Watch the following video, guess what communication styles are featured and decide whether they are effective or not.



Mention the communication Style

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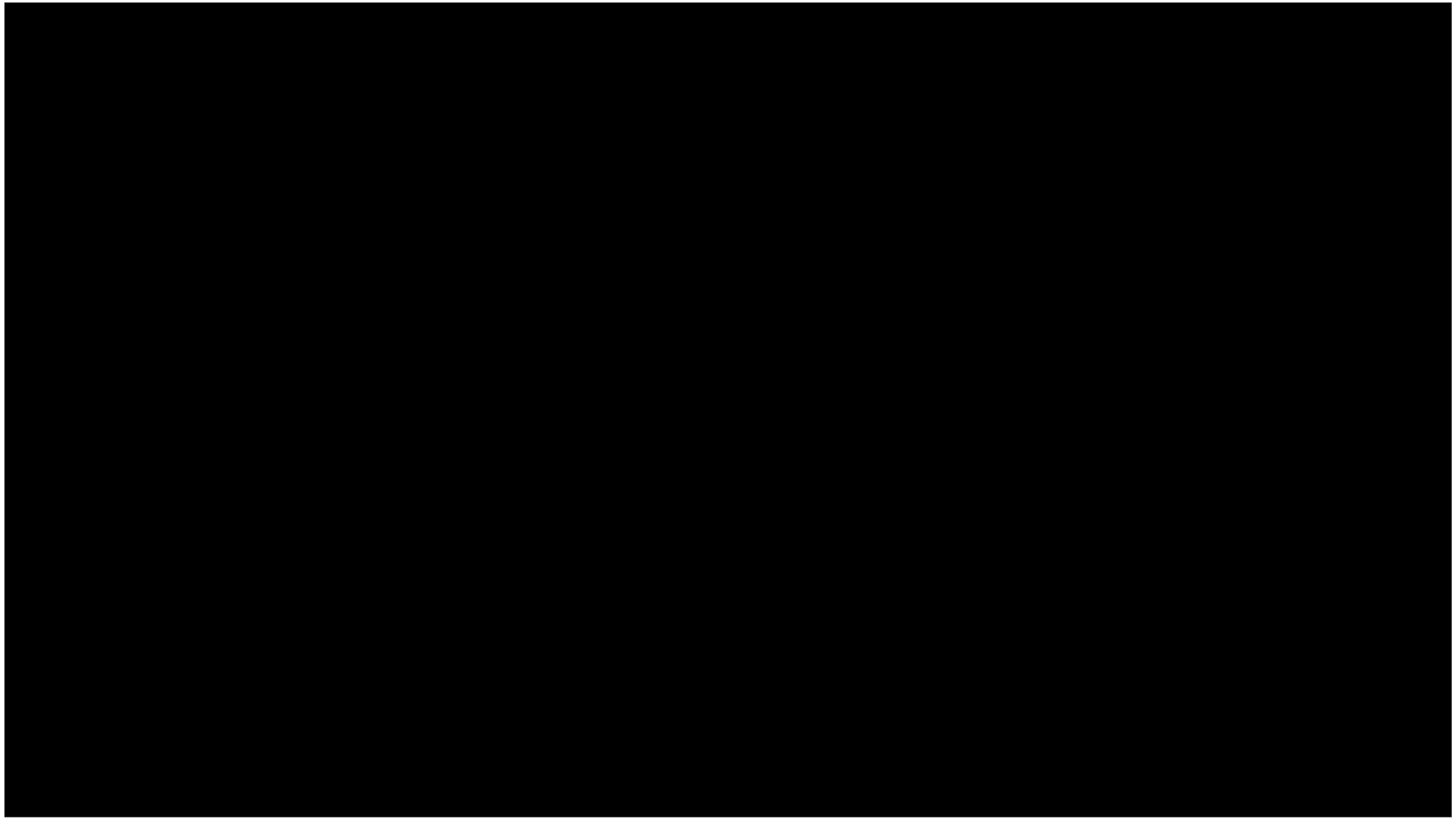

Aggressive Communication

- Individuals who express their feelings and opinions in a way that violates the rights of others. They may even be verbally or physically abusive. They might believe:
  - ‘I’m superior and right and you’re inferior and wrong.’
  - ‘It’s all your fault.’
  - ‘I’ll get my way no matter what.’

Mention the communication Style

Passive Aggressive Communication

- individuals who appear passive on the surface but are really acting out of anger in a subtle, indirect way. They usually feel powerless, stuck and resentful. Their perspectives might be:
- ‘I’m weak and resentful, so I sabotage, frustrate and disrupt.’
- ‘I’m powerless to deal with you head on so I must use guerrilla warfare.’
- ‘I will appear cooperative but I’m not.’

Assertive Communication

- individuals who clearly state their opinions and feelings. They value themselves, their time and their needs and respect the rights of others. They might feel:
  - ‘We are equally entitled to express ourselves respectfully to one another.’
  - ‘I am confident about who I am.’
  - ‘I’m 100% responsible for my own happiness.’
- **Assertive communication** is the preference as it allows the individual to take care of themselves and is fundamental to healthy relationships. For the other three styles, encouraging colleagues to share their opinions and feelings, and to do so appropriately, is key.

Read the following situations, and decide which of the responses under each one is ASSERTIVE, PASSIVE AGGRESSIVE, AGGRESSIVE AND PASSIVE.

You are a department head and have given your employees a deadline to finish a certain task. One of your employees did not meet the deadline. **You respond by saying:**

- I can help you with the task. And if you need more time, I can wait. (Passive)
- You are careless and a loser. (Aggressive)
- You are very busy I know. You cannot find time for us. (Passive - aggressive)
- You need to step up and do your work or there will be a penalty. (Assertive)

Read the following situations, and decide which of the responses under each one is ASSERTIVE, PASSIVE AGGRESSIVE, AGGRESSIVE AND PASSIVE.

Your colleague asks you to complete the tasks she has for the day. She says she wants to leave early due to an emergency. She always does that and you end up doing all her work. She also never gives you credit. **You respond by saying:**

- I am sorry. I cannot help you with your tasks. ( )
- I have a lot to do, but yes I will help you. Don't worry. ( )
- You don't deserve your job or your pay. You are lazy. (Passive-aggressive)
- Yeah sure. Your emergencies are more important than your work. ( )

Assertive Aggressive Passive

Read the following situations, and decide which of the responses under each one is ASSERTIVE, PASSIVE AGGRESSIVE, AGGRESSIVE AND PASSIVE.

Your brother has been staying with you in your house for six months. He has an apartment of his own but your house is bigger and closer to his work. You want him to leave. You ask him politely when is he expected to leave. He answers that he doesn't think he will be leaving soon. **You respond by saying:**

- I am sick of you staying here. LEAVE now! (Aggressive)
- Okay stay, but can you at least pay for the groceries? (Passive)
- I know that your apartment is not up to your standards, diva. (Passive-aggressive)
- Assertive: _____